

Size of the motherboard matters too. You cannot put an ATX motherboard into a cabinet built for micro-ATX or mini-ITX motherboards. In addition, when you connect all the components together, you are going to have a mess of cables inside the cabinet. Certain features which help manage cables (clips and cutouts available at the right places) demand consideration.



Zip ties are cheap and they make cable management much simpler

Don't forget to keep some zip ties handy when doing cable management.

Inadequate or under-optimised airflow can cause your system to abnormally heat up. Few cabinets sport ventilation at the top with options to attach exhaust fans. Also, some of them ship with fans near the hard drive bay to keep them cool while you push them to the limits (yes, hard drives do heat up). More the number of fan mounts, the cooler your system can potentially run. Remember though, you need to incorporate some amount of air intake as you increase the number of fans. In case you have missed the downside of all those fans, here it is – they let your internal components collect dust a lot faster. Hence, you should also look for cabinets that have dust filters installed over the fan mounts.

Which case is good for me?

Basic rig

The basic PC contains minimal components with low heat-dissipation requirements. Most cabinets available in the local market should be good enough. You need to verify the motherboard sizes supported by the cabinet before buying these OEM cabinets.

Entry level gaming

Corsair Carbide SPEC-O1 coming at approximately INR 3K is a good fit for the needs here. It comes with enough fan-mounting options, support for up to four HDDs and two optical drives, large side window panel, cable management features and a cool-looking build.

Mid-range gaming

Corsair Carbide SPEC-O1 would serve the purpose well in this segment too. We couldn't find any better at the price for the features it includes.